

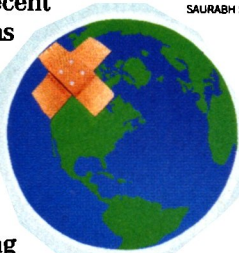
A Climate for Change



The world is once again in the throes of some of the freakiest weather phenomenon ever experienced in recent times. In the Indian subcontinent, in the first half of the monsoons, twice the normal number of depressions have already occurred bringing heavy rains and large-scale floods. There was even an unusual occurrence of a cyclone over the Arabian Sea that caused death and destruction in Oman. Elsewhere in the world, Britain and Germany have experienced one of its wettest summers. Earlier, two record breaking heat waves affected much of Europe. The World Meteorological Organisation has said that the overall global land surface temperatures have risen to the highest levels ever recorded. Scientists now agree that the world's climate is not only changing adversely as a result of global warming but also more rapidly than estimated before. Much of this has been caused by the unprecedented man-made increase of carbon dioxide levels in the atmosphere.

While all this is bleak news, there is also, well, a climate for change. In a recent international poll, urban Indians rated global warming as one of the biggest threats the country faces, putting it second only to terror attacks. Across the world, there is a dramatic increase in the levels of concern about global warming and the clamour to do something about it. On the non-governmental front, the recent Live Earth concert performances across five continents drew record responses. At the G-8 summit in Germany, climate change was again number one on the agenda and even the US, the world's largest greenhouse gas emitter and a perennial treaty blocker, was forced to yield ground. All this may lead to a far more effective global climate change treaty being formulated in the next couple of years.

While India can rightfully argue that its per capita level of carbon dioxide is still almost 20 times less than that of the US, it doesn't mean we should not act. We should tap the concern of the young by searching for some of the best ways in which each of us, as citizens, could contribute to reduce emissions. Industries that observe the best green practices should be given incentives and awards, as should architects who design eco-friendly buildings. Some of these green standards should be made mandatory by the Government. Meanwhile, booklets publicising these should be made freely available and innovative advertising campaigns could be launched to create awareness. Unlike in the past we do not have the gift of time, so we should act fast.



SAURABH SINGH

SEEDHI BAAT ON AAJ TAK

"We aren't saying Bapu was a bad father"

ACTOR AKSHAYE KHANNA SPOKE TO EDITOR PRABHU CHAWLA about his recent film, career and relationship with his father

Q. Tell us about your role in the film Gandhi, My Father.

A. It's a nice role with a wonderful story. We are not portraying Mahatma Gandhi as the father of the nation but as the father of a son.

Q. Is it about the clash between a son and a father?

A. You can call it a difference of opinion, not a clash.

Q. There are very little documents available on Hari Lal. So how did you do the research for the role?

A. I read a book *Hari Lal Gandhi Ek Dukhad Atma* by Chandu Lal Dalal and the letters he wrote to Bapu and Ba.

Q. Didn't you have second thoughts about playing such a rebellious role considering the way he is revered in the country?

A. Our story does not say Bapu was a bad father. It is based on his failed relationship with one of his four sons, Hari Lal.

Q. How challenging was this role?

A. It was a challenge to play out the entire lifetime of a man—from his 18-year-old self till the age of 60, when he dies. This has been the best film of my career.

Q. You come across as an intelligent actor.

A. It's good that I am being offered all kinds of roles.

Q. What do you think about being compared to your father?

A. It's a natural thing. Nothing wrong with being compared to one's father.

Q. Do you imitate him?

A. I don't imitate anyone.

Q. Why did you choose films as a career?

A. I wanted to join the industry since I was 15 or 16 years old though my father wanted me to pursue higher studies. But he was okay with it once he came to know I was serious.

Q. Do you want your father's films to be remade?

A. There are a few like *Mere Apne*, *Mera Gaon Mera Desh* that can be remade. I would love to play the roles my father did.

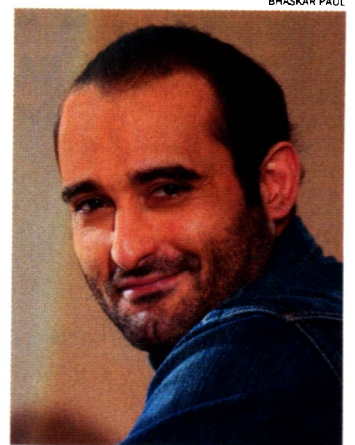
Q. What lessons have you learnt from your father?

A. He has lived life according to his own wishes.

Q. You have not been a successful solo actor.

A. I agree, but I am trying my best.

Seedhi Baat is telecast on Aaj Tak at 8.30 p.m. every Sunday and 3.30 p.m. every Monday



BHASKAR PAUL

Full text of the interview at:

<http://www.indiatoday.com>

